



MENTAL STRENGTH
Self-confidence

Self-confidence

2x

People who are self-confident are 2 x more likely to have higher levels of resilience

99%

% respondents with **high levels** of resilience who are self-confident

49%

% respondents with **average / low levels** of resilience who are self-confident

What is Self-confidence?



Self-confidence is the belief in our own abilities and chances of future success. It is in large part based on our past experiences.



Self-confidence is based on perceptions, both of our capabilities and of what a task or challenge requires.



We are not born with self-confidence, it comes from success, experience and our environment, and it is something we can develop.



Research shows that higher self-confidence results in greater motivation for a task. Difficult situations are more likely to be perceived as opportunities rather than threats and more ambitious goals are set and achieved.



In sports performance, self-confidence has been found to account for 24% of the variation in achievement (Woodman & Hardy, 2003).

How Do We Assess Our Own Self-confidence?



ACTUAL EXPERIENCES

The things we have done before and have succeeded at – generally challenging but achievable situations with similarities to the current task.



MODELLING

Learning and being inspired by the experiences of role models.



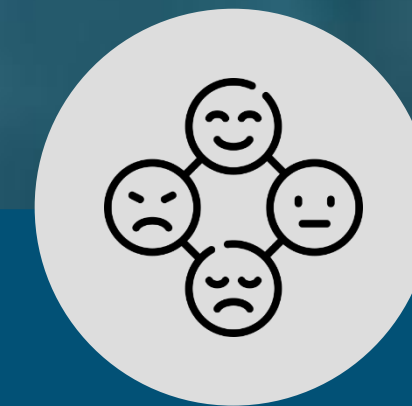
SOCIAL COMPARISON

Seeing others like yourself succeed at something – “If they can do it, why can’t I?”



SOCIAL PERSUASION

Being convinced by someone else – an Inspirational Speaker, a boss who believes in us when we doubt ourselves, a coach who guides successful performance.



EMOTIONAL AROUSAL

How we manage our emotions in relation to the events around us. The physical feedback we experience (fear, anxiety, fatigue, nausea), informs how self-confident we feel.

EXERCISE

Self-confidence Assessment

HIGH SELF-
CONFIDENCE

1

Describe situations
in which you are
confident

2

What is driving
this?

3

How does it
make you feel?



“Believe you can and
you’re halfway there.”

Theodore Roosevelt

LOW SELF-
CONFIDENCE

1

Describe situations
in which you are
less confident

2

What is making
you feel less
confident?

3

How does it make
you feel?

4

What step could
you take to move
forward?

BEST PRACTICE

How To Build Your Self-confidence



'Success breeds success' – by taking small risks and working successfully towards a goal, you build the confidence to set more ambitious goals (the self-confidence cycle).



Put yourself in situations that stretch you.



In unfamiliar situations, break your goal down into tasks that you have / haven't done before. Assess your capability and note down in which areas you require new skills or knowledge and how to acquire them.



Find confident role models, observe their behaviour and ask about the experiences that built their confidence.



Reflect on accomplishments that made you proud and challenge your inner critic.



Increasing your confidence in one area, e.g. sport, can have a knock-on effect on other areas.





Self-confidence



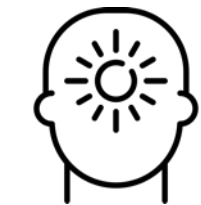
What are the
benefits of high
self-confidence?



Better ability to cope and thrive under stress



Better ability to influence and persuade others



Increased positive attitude and happiness



Enhanced sense of feeling valued (by yourself and others)



Improved performance at work



Greater freedom from social anxiety



Increased energy and motivation

Self-confidence



EXERCISE 1

The Success Bank

This is an exercise to reflect on and document your past successes and to think about the abilities that you have that contributed to the success.

You can refer to them in the future when you are asked to take on new tasks where you may be having doubts about your capabilities and chance of success.

- 1 For every situation in which you have experienced success, write down on a separate piece of paper (one per situation) the following;

 -  Describe the situation
 -  Which capabilities helped you to be successful?
 -  How did your success make you feel?
- 2 Once you have written it down, put it in the 'Success Bank'. This could be a desk drawer, a filing cabinet, pinned to the wall or stored electronically.
- 3 Every time you have a new success, document it and add it to the Success Bank. You can also add recognitions from managers, peers or customers.
- 4 When you are faced with a situation where you are lacking confidence and starting to doubt whether you have the skills to complete a task, go to the Success Bank and read **out loud** the different examples of your past achievements and recognitions, together with the skills that made you successful.

Self-confidence



EXERCISE 2

Build confidence by getting out of your comfort zone

This exercise is all about taking a small risk by getting out of your comfort zone by doing something that in the past you have avoided or wouldn't normally do.

Comfort to Growth



Self-confidence



EXERCISE 2

Build confidence by getting out of your comfort zone

This exercise is all about taking a small risk by getting out of your comfort zone by doing something that in the past you have avoided or wouldn't normally do.

1

Identify something that you have avoided in the past or wouldn't normally do.

e.g. speaking up in a meeting at work, starting a new hobby or sport, learning a new skill, joining a different group e.g drama or choir.

2

Commit to it for a minimum of 2 months and be consistent throughout the period, taking small steps along the way.

3

Make it easier by having a buddy who has agreed to do it with you. In this way you are more likely to keep going and you can motivate each other along the way.

4

After 2 months, reflect on the progress you have made. How do you feel before? How do you feel now? Has it helped build your confidence?